immediately began its campaign to take control of UNRWA, and that same year, in the elections for the UNRWA workers' union, out of the twenty-seven members of the union, twenty-five Hamas members were elected.

UNRWA employs thirty thousand people in the territories, about ten thousand of whom are in Gaza. UNRWA's annual budget is about $1.25 billion, and the United States contributes a fifth ($250 million) of that amount. I do not risk slander if I say that the US government, which initiated legislation against funders of terrorist organizations, has itself contributed to this day about $16.5 billion to an organization that has become a terrorist tool. If the US government should request it, Israel would be able to present it with an irrefutable case full of legal evidence that UNRWA is today an organization operated by Hamas.

Even putting aside the issue of terrorism, it is hard for me to believe that US president Donald Trump would be indifferent to a waste of $250 million a year that is clearly intended, not to solve a problem, but rather to perpetuate the same problem and inflate it more and more each year. Many believe that the Palestinians have moderated their position on the "right of return" of refugees and will eventually agree to the return of a symbolic number of refugees to the State of Israel, with the rest receiving financial compensation. I doubt this, because of the cumulative weight of all of the following considerations:

- There is no group of refugees in the world that has received as sweeping a definition as the Palestinian refugees. This definition has increased the number of refugees from seven hundred thousand in 1948 to five million in 2016.
- There is no other group of refugees in the world whose full right to return to their homeland has been recognized by the UN (see General Assembly Resolution 194 III). This resolution created the ethos of the "right of return."
- The Palestinian leadership has done everything, from 1947 to this day, to maintain the refugees as such. In other words, the leadership has condemned millions of Palestinians to give up their lives, their futures, their pride as human beings, and their standard of living in order to preserve and nurture their status as refugees.